FINISH THE IDIOM

64 ENGLISH IDIOMS
MEANING AND EXAMPLE

1 **Actions speak louder than words**
What you do matters more than what you say.
He promises a lot, but actions speak louder than words.

2 **Back to square one**
Back to the beginning after a failure.
The client rejected the design, so it's back to square one.

3 **Be snowed under**
Have far too much work.
I'm snowed under until Friday.

4 **Be up in the air**
Still uncertain, not decided.
Our summer plans are up in the air.

5 **Beat around the bush**
Avoid saying what you really mean.
Stop beating around the bush and tell me the price.

6 **Beggars can't be choosers**
If you have no choice, you take what you are given.
It's a tiny flat, but beggars can't be choosers.

7 **The best of both worlds**
A situation where you get the advantages of two things.
Working two days at home is the best of both worlds.

8 **Better late than never**
Doing something late is better than not doing it.
He apologised after a year, but better late than never.

9 **Better safe than sorry**
It is wiser to be careful than to take a risk.
Take an umbrella, better safe than sorry.

10 **A blessing in disguise**
Something that seems bad at first but turns out to be good.
Losing that job was a blessing in disguise.

11 **Call it a day**
Stop working on something for now.
We've done enough, let's call it a day.

12 **Cut to the chase**
Get to the important part.
Let's cut to the chase, how much do you want?

13 **The devil is in the detail**
The small details are where the real problems are.
The contract looks fine, but the devil is in the detail.

14 **Don't count your chickens before they hatch**
Don't rely on something good until it has actually happened.
You haven't signed yet, so don't count your chickens.

15 **Don't put all your eggs in one basket**
Don't risk everything on one plan.
Apply to three universities, don't put all your eggs in one basket.

16 **A double-edged sword**
Something with a good side and a bad side.
Working from home is a double-edged sword.

17 **The early bird catches the worm**
The person who acts first gets the advantage.
Tickets go fast, so the early bird catches the worm.

18 **Easier said than done**
It sounds simple but it is hard in practice.
Just stop worrying? Easier said than done.

19 **The elephant in the room**
An obvious problem that nobody wants to talk about.
Nobody mentioned the money, the elephant in the room.

20 **Every cloud has a silver lining**
Every bad situation has something good in it.
The flight was cancelled, but every cloud has a silver lining, we got a free hotel.

21 **Get cold feet**
Become too nervous to do something you planned.
He got cold feet the night before the wedding.

22 **Get the hang of something**
Learn how to do something after a bit of practice.
Give it a week and you'll get the hang of it.

23 **Get your act together**
Start organising yourself and behaving properly.
If he doesn't get his act together, he'll fail.

24 **Go down a rabbit hole**
Get lost in something complicated for a long time.
I went down a rabbit hole reading about volcanoes.

25 **Go pear-shaped**
Go badly wrong.
The whole trip went pear-shaped on day two.

26 **Go with the flow**
Accept the situation and do what others are doing.
There's no plan tonight, we'll just go with the flow.

27 **The grass is always greener on the other side**
Other people's situations always look better than yours.
She misses her old job, but the grass is always greener.

28 **A grey area**
A situation where the rules are not clear.
Working from abroad is a bit of a grey area.

29 **Have a chip on your shoulder**
Stay angry about something unfair that happened to you.
He's had a chip on his shoulder since they passed him over.

30 **Have a lot on your plate**
Have a lot of work or problems to deal with.
Ask someone else, she's got a lot on her plate.

31 **Have second thoughts**
Start to doubt a decision you made.
I'm having second thoughts about the flat.

32 **Hit the nail on the head**
Say exactly the right thing about a problem.
You've hit the nail on the head, it's a money problem.

33 **In the long run**
Over a long period of time in the future.
Walking to work saves money in the long run.

34 **In two minds**
Undecided about something.
I'm in two minds about taking the job.

35 **It takes two to tango**
Both people are responsible, not just one.
Don't blame her alone, it takes two to tango.

36 **Make ends meet**
Earn just enough money to pay for what you need.
With two kids, they're struggling to make ends meet.

37 **Miss the boat**
Lose a chance because you were too slow.
Book now or you'll miss the boat.

38 **No pain, no gain**
You have to suffer a little to get results.
My legs are killing me, but no pain, no gain.

39 **Not my cup of tea**
Not something you enjoy.
Horror films are not my cup of tea.

40 **Off the top of my head**
Without checking or thinking carefully.
Off the top of my head, I'd say about forty people came.

41 **On the fence**
Unable to decide between two sides.
I'm still on the fence about moving abroad.

42 **On the same page**
In agreement, understanding things the same way.
Before we start, let's make sure we're on the same page.

43 **On the tip of my tongue**
You almost remember a word but can't quite say it.
His name is on the tip of my tongue.

44 **Out of sight, out of mind**
You forget about things you cannot see.
I put the biscuits in the cupboard, out of sight, out of mind.

45 **Out of the blue**
Suddenly and unexpectedly.
She called me out of the blue after ten years.

46 **A pain in the neck**
Something or someone annoying.
Filling in these forms is a pain in the neck.

47 **A piece of cake**
Very easy.
The exam was a piece of cake.

48 **Play it by ear**
Decide as you go, without a fixed plan.
We've booked the flights, the rest we'll play by ear.

49 **Practice makes perfect**
You improve at something by doing it repeatedly.
Keep speaking every day, practice makes perfect.

50 **Pull someone's leg**
Joke with someone by telling them something untrue.
Relax, I'm only pulling your leg.

51 **Put your foot in it**
Say something embarrassing or tactless by accident.
I asked about his wife, then really put my foot in it.

52 **Ring a bell**
Sound familiar.
That name rings a bell, but I can't place her.

53 **A slippery slope**
A small bad step that leads to much worse things.
Skipping one class is a slippery slope.

54 **Stick to your guns**
Refuse to change your opinion or decision.
They pushed him hard, but he stuck to his guns.

55 **A storm in a teacup**
A lot of fuss about something unimportant.
The whole argument was a storm in a teacup.

56 **Take a rain check**
Say no for now but yes another time.
I'll take a rain check on dinner, I'm exhausted.

57 **Take it with a pinch of salt**
Don't believe it completely.
He exaggerates, so take it with a pinch of salt.

58 **There's no use crying over spilt milk**
There is no point being upset about something you can't change.
The car's sold now, no use crying over spilt milk.

59 **Throw in the towel**
Give up.
After three rejections he threw in the towel.

60 **Touch wood**
Said to avoid bad luck after talking about good luck.
I've never broken a bone, touch wood.

61 **When in Rome, do as the Romans do**
Follow the local customs when you are somewhere new.
They eat at ten here, so when in Rome, do as the Romans do.

62 **When it rains, it pours**
Bad things tend to happen all at once.
The boiler broke, then the car died. When it rains, it pours.

63 **You can't have your cake and eat it**
You can't have two good things that don't go together.
You want the money and the free time? You can't have your cake and eat it.

64 **You reap what you sow**
You get the results of your own actions.
He was rude to everyone for years, and you reap what you sow.